

The Muddy Footprints: answers

Year 4 · 11 marks. Accept any sensible answer that is backed up by the text.

1. On the windowsill. (1 mark)

Finding information (2b). A fact to find in the first paragraph.

2. The muddy prints leading from the back door to the window. (1 mark)

Finding information (2b). Putting events in the right order in the child's head.

3. They were small and round, had four toes, and had tiny claw marks (any two). (2 marks)

Inference (2d). Using specific details from the text as evidence is the heart of inference.

4. determined (1 mark)

Word meaning (2a). Choosing the word that shows a character's attitude builds vocabulary and careful reading.

5. A tuft of ginger fur (accept: Biscuit). (1 mark)

Finding information (2b). A second clue to find in the text, which also helps the child follow how the mystery is solved.

6. Biscuit knew he had done something wrong by taking the bread. (2 marks)

Inference (2d). A single word that carries a lot of meaning, so the child has to think about why the writer chose it.

7. A dog (a cat answer can be accepted if two sensible details are given). Evidence, for example: claw marks in the prints, thumping tail, wet nose, whiskers, "you are in big trouble". (2 marks)

Inference (2d). The text never names the animal. The child collects clues to decide, and there is room for a reasoned answer.

8. B (1 mark)

Summarising (2c). Choosing the best summary tests whether the child grasped the whole story.

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